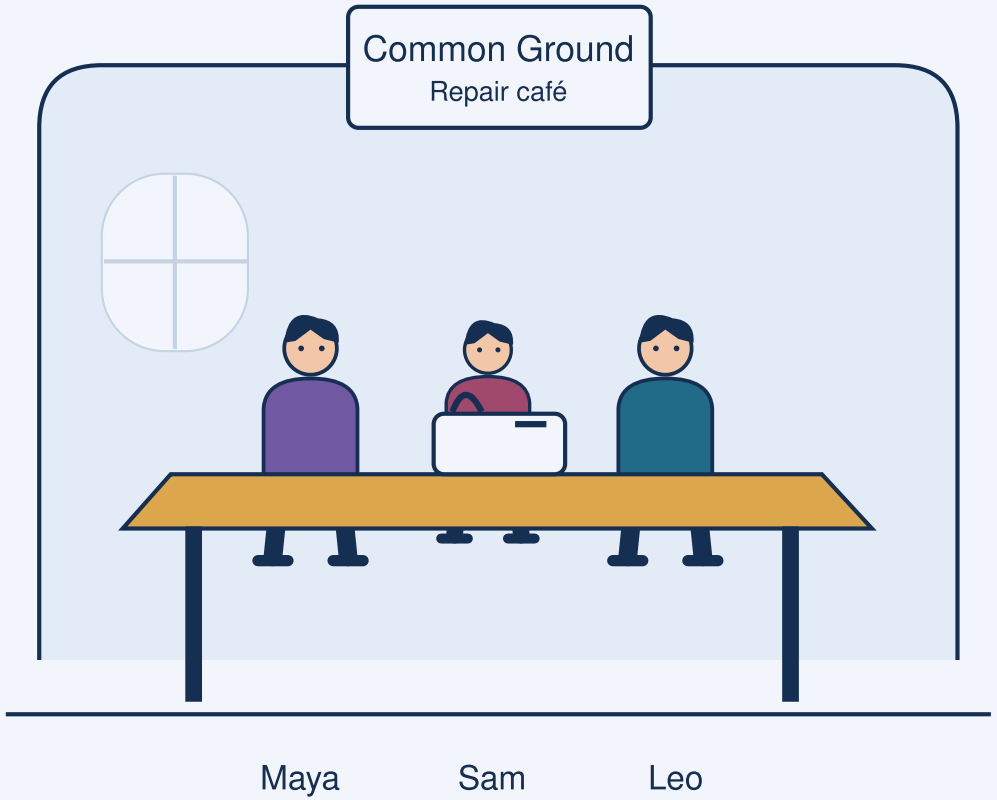
# “I chose it” quietly becomes “it must be right.”

An original story at the Common Ground repair café.






A fictional story. A real question about people.

# What would you do?

## What makes honest revision easier?

A Review failures and compare options afresh.

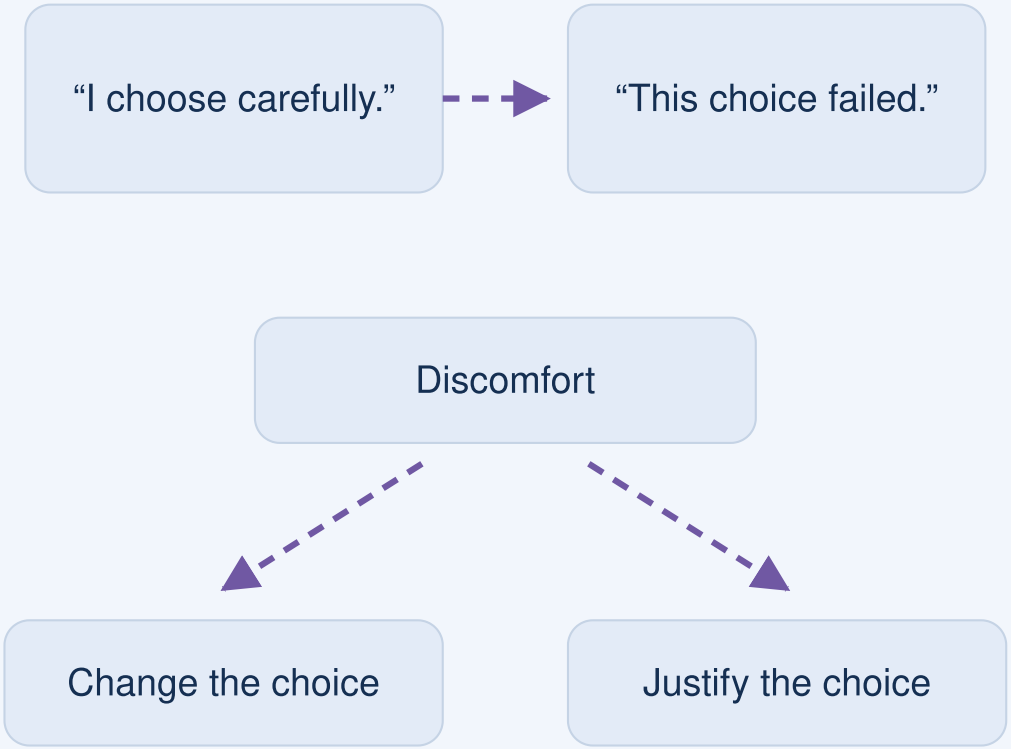
B Remind Maya that a competent coordinator would know better.

C Keep the system until the investment feels worthwhile.

Suggested answer: A. This makes the decision about outcomes rather than defending identity.

# Inconsistency can feel uncomfortable.

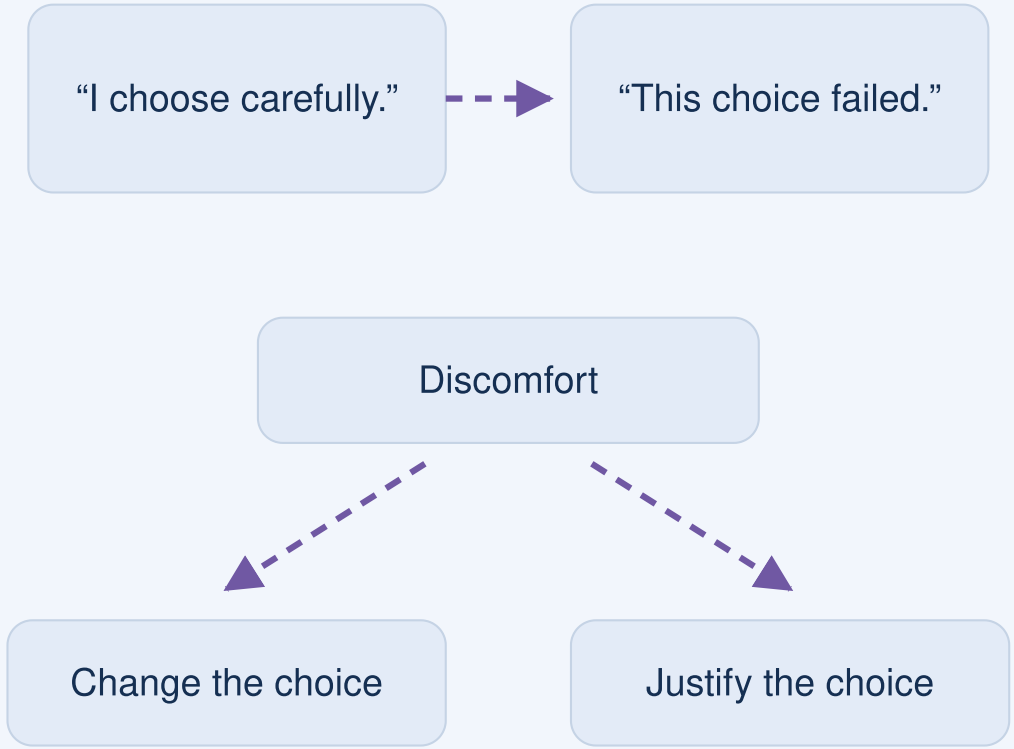
- “I make careful decisions.”
- “This decision is causing problems.”
- Repair the action—or reinterpret the evidence.




Inconsistency can lead to revision or justification.

# Give the future a fresh vote.

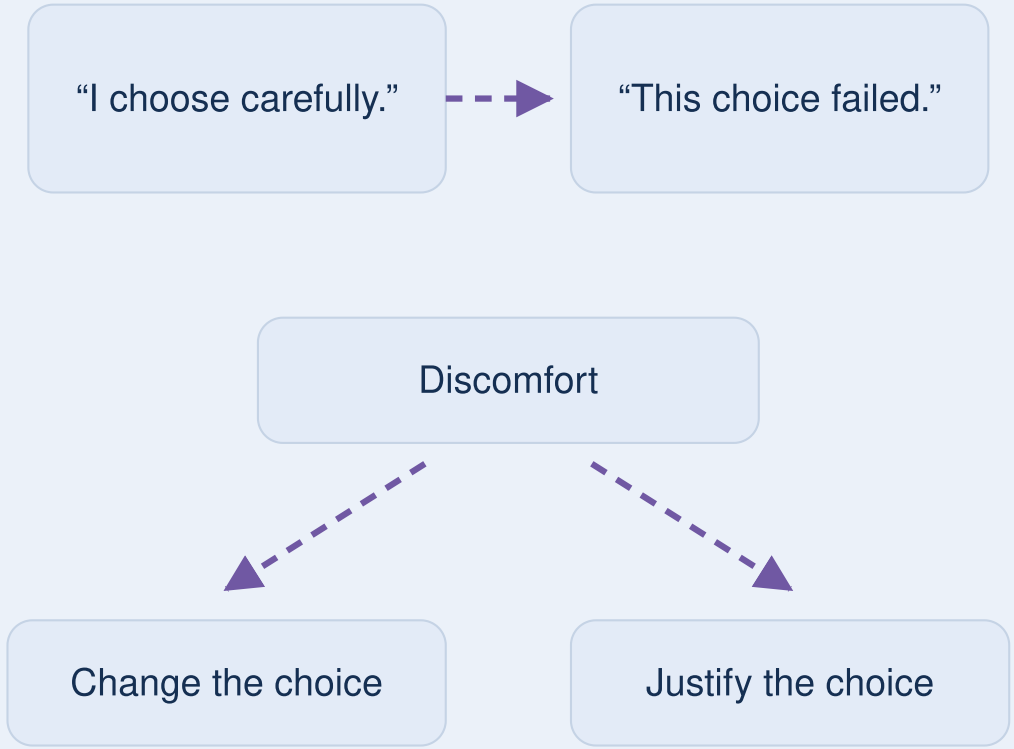
- Past cost: already incurred.
- Future cost: still avoidable.
- Compare consequences from today.




Inconsistency can lead to revision or justification.

# What can we really conclude?

Specific dissonance demonstrations have uneven evidence. Vaidis and colleagues' preregistered 2024 multilab replication did not support the primary predicted high-choice versus low-choice attitude difference in one induced-compliance paradigm. This challenges the tested procedure. It neither confirms every dissonance claim nor disproves every version of the theory. Keep the influential framework separate from confidence in a particular demonstration.




Conceptual illustration; no research data are plotted.

# Try the idea somewhere new.

## Switching costs £100; keeping the tool costs £300 in future support. Benefits are equal. What matters?

A The large fee already paid.

B The lower avoidable future cost of switching.

C Only the emotional discomfort of switching.

Suggested answer: B. Under the stated assumptions, £100 is less than £300. Real choices also compare risks.

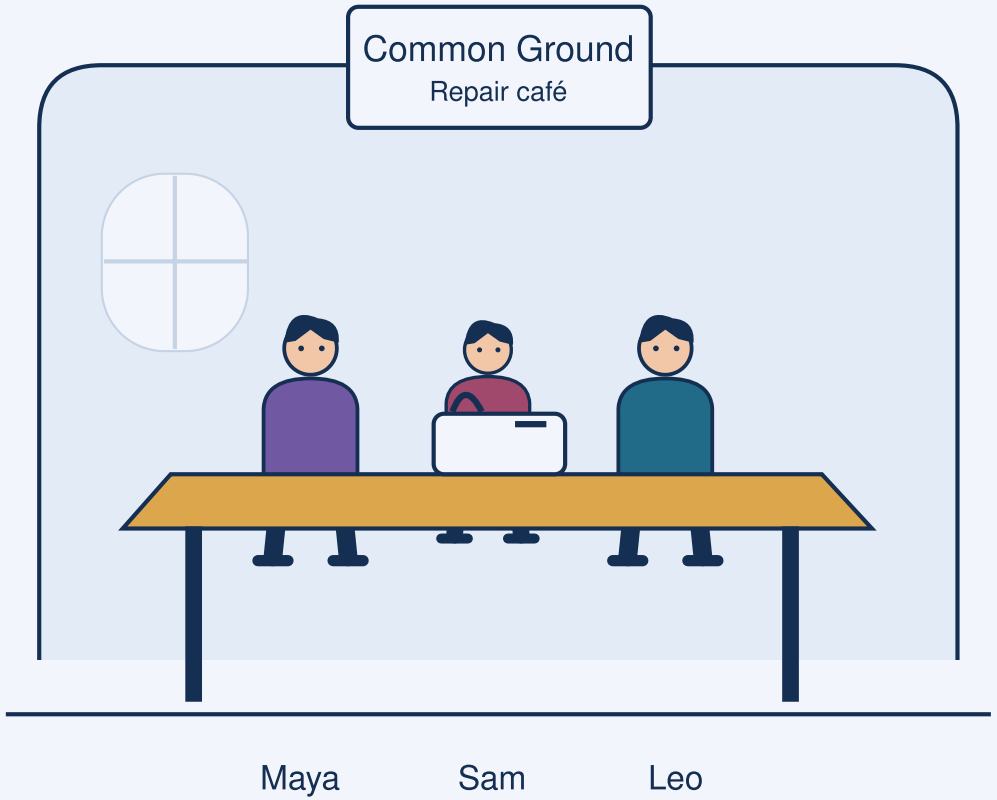
# Close your notes. Explain it.

> Name two ways to reduce dissonance.

> When can a past investment still matter?

1. Change behavior or belief, or add a justification; context affects the response.

2. When it changes future consequences, such as switching costs or usable skills.

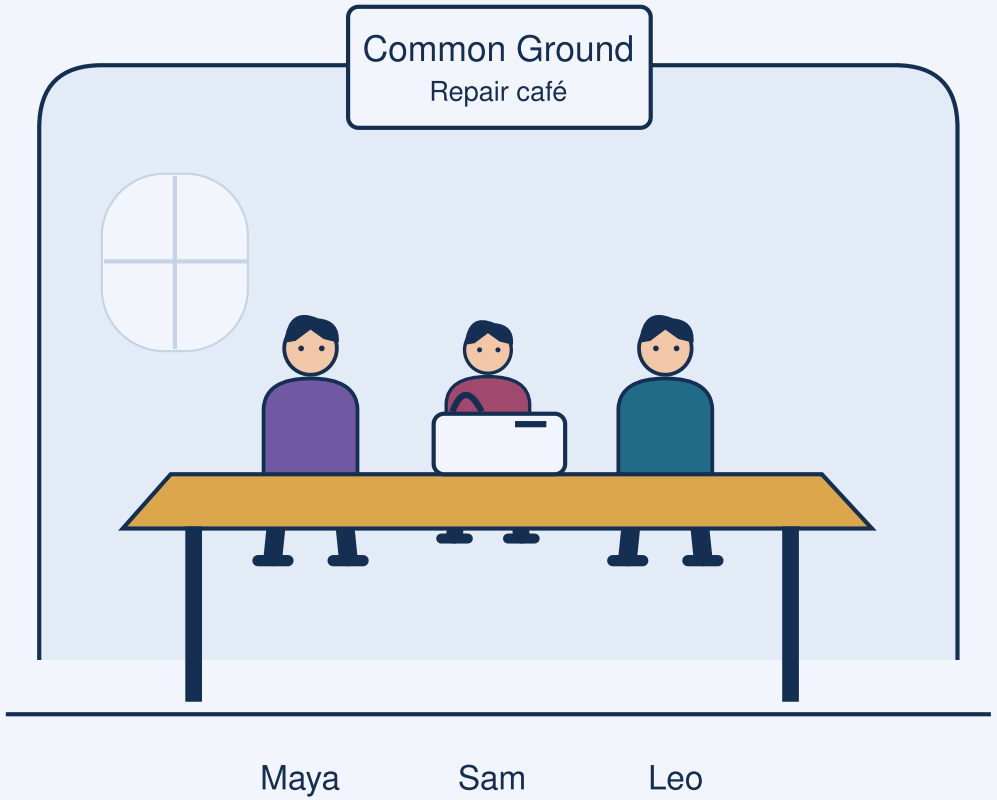



Maya, Sam and Leo at the repair café.

# Carry one idea into your week.

Revisit a small commitment you can change. List the future benefits and avoidable costs of continuing or stopping. Write a sentence that permits correction without attacking your character.

Revisit tomorrow and in a week.
Explain it without notes, then use a different example.






Take the question into a different setting.